Restructure Proposal: Data Function

A framework for managing Geoff's departure — and positioning the data function for sustainable, technically sound operations.

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The Situation & The Proposal

Context

Geoff is leaving. That leaves Devon as the sole member of the data team. The question isn't whether responsibilities shift — it's how we formalize the shift.

Two Options on the Table

The Proposal

Transition the data function from the CFO org to Engineering (Devon → Luke → Trevor). Formalize Devon's expanded role as **Principal Analyst**. Geoff's responsibilities are redistributed — not lost.

Backfill the Director

Hire a new director to manage a team of one

→ **To Luke:** Escalation path, budget ownership, headcount decisions, technical oversight

Restructure

Move data to Engineering, expand Devon's title and scope

→ **To Devon:** Prioritization, stakeholder communication, project management, cross-departmental coordination

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Why Restructure — Not Backfill, and Why Engineering

The Case Against Backfilling

Director-level cost to manage a team of one

3–6 month search and ramp on a stack they didn't build

During that window, Devon operates independently — proving the proposed model already works

Why Engineering Is the Right Home

The stack is infrastructure: **Stitch, dbt, Snowflake, Looker, Polytomic** — all system-layer work

Luke's team already owns everything else system-related

Shared concerns: deployments, uptime, version control, incident response

Technical decisions — tooling, architecture, debt — require **technical oversight**

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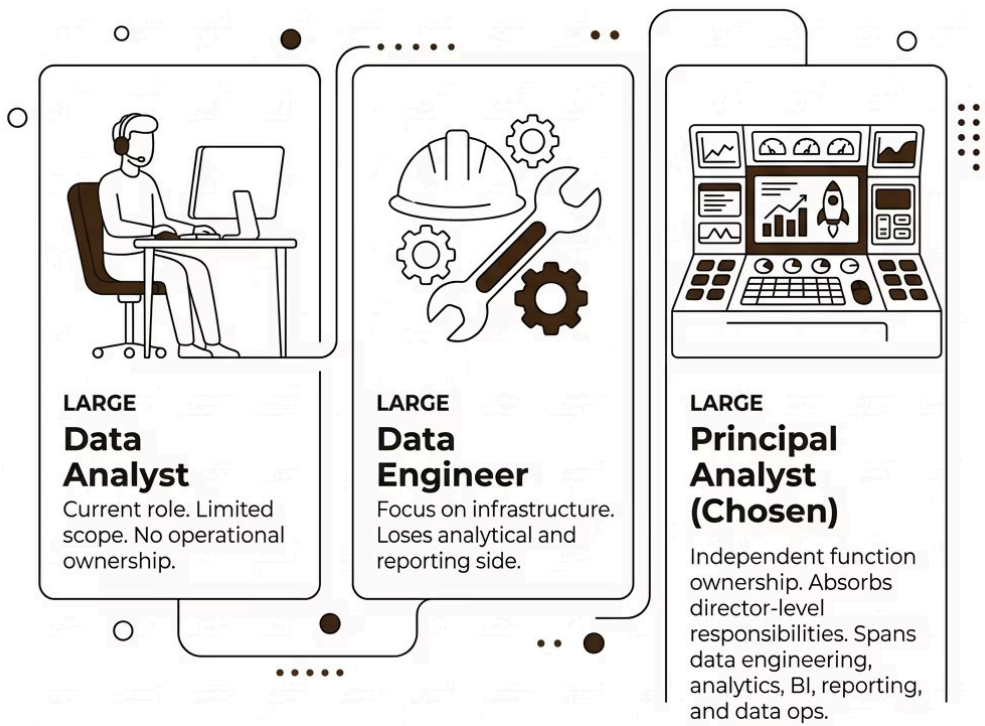
Why *Principal Analyst*?



What the Title Signals

1. **Absorbing director-level responsibilities:** prioritization, stakeholder communication, project management
2. **Existing scope** already spans data engineering, analytics engineering, BI development, reporting, and data ops
3. **"Analyst" preserves** the reporting and analytical function — "Engineer" would misrepresent half the role
4. **"Principal" reflects** independent ownership of a function, including the operational judgment Geoff previously held

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Anticipated Questions

"Why not report to the CFO directly?"

Possible — but a CFO managing a solo technical infrastructure role isn't a natural organizational fit. The work looks far more like what Luke's team does than what Finance does day-to-day.

"What if we want to grow the data team later?"

Engineering already has hiring frameworks, code review processes, and development standards that apply directly. Growing under Finance would mean building all of that from scratch.

"Does Luke want this?"

TBD — this hasn't been discussed with him yet. That conversation is a logical next step if leadership is aligned on the direction.

"How does this get done with one person?"

Geoff is a significant technical contributor — this is a real capacity gap, not just a management gap. That's why **d7dev** is in development: a platform that systematizes ETL workflows, validation, knowledge base, and automated checks. The foundation is in place; the roadmap targets the highest-gap areas first.

"What changes on day one?"

Nothing operational. The reporting line moves. All existing work, deliverables, and stakeholder relationships continue without interruption.

Bottom line: This proposal formalizes a role expansion that is already happening — with the right title, the right reporting structure, and a plan to bridge the capacity gap.

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